There is more and more talk of attempting to create a new structure for the country, a federal one, something like Switzerland. One canton for the Orthodox, one for the secular Jews. The idea is good, but we are not Swiss and our bickering will not end so easily. Moreover, our neighbors will make sure that we do not get the time to make such complicated constitutional changes …

Friday, April 28

Today, photos taken by a passenger on the *Altalena* were published in *Haaretz*. It seems to be the same group pictured in the four snapshots, probably Jews from DP camps and, on the last photo, kids from Ben Shemen who came to greet them on arrival, before the massacre. There was intense hatred between political groups, even then.

To this day, it remains difficult to apportion blame for the killings that cost the lives of sixteen of the passengers of the ship. I was one of the passengers on the *Altalena*, probably the youngest. Whatever good reasons Ben-Gurion had for destroying the ship, there was no cause for shooting people who had leaped into the sea and were swimming toward the shore, and even less for declaring afterward that the gun which sunk the ship was "a blessed gun."

Saturday, April 29

Tens of thousands are gathering for the demonstration in Tel Aviv. Thousands are protesting all over the country. In Netanya, two opposed groups will demonstrate facing each other. Tomorrow the Knesset reconvenes for three months; while Netanyahu wants to put the judicial overhaul on a backburner, it is not certain that he will succeed.